Harshdeep Athawale

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Education

Thapar Institute of Engineering & Technology — Patiala, India
B.E. in Computer Engineering — *Aug. 2024 – June. 2028*

Experience

HackerOne — Dec. 2025 – Present
Security Researcher (Part-time) — *San Francisco, CA (Remote)*

- Submitted **35+ vulnerability reports** to programs including Goldman Sachs, Red Bull, Flipkart, Adobe, Netflix, NVIDIA, Anduril, Coca-Cola, and Superdrug – headlined by a **Critical (CVSS 9.1)** GraphQL flaw at Red Bull exposing employee PII, and an unauthenticated API exposing 892 employees' PII with production database write access.
- Found high-impact **infra and supply-chain** bugs: RCE in a build pipeline, a subdomain takeover at Anduril, and exposed source maps leaking OAuth secrets at Flipkart/Myntra.
- Discovered **hardcoded OAuth secrets** leaking NHS medical data and an appointment IDOR at Superdrug, preventing a potential patient data breach.

Iris Intelligence — April. 2026 – June. 2026
Security Engineer (Internship) — *Delhi, India (Hybrid)*

- Identified and remediated **IDOR, SQL injection, authentication bypass,** and **RCE** vulnerabilities across REST APIs and authentication flows, securing a platform serving **5K+ users**.
- Performed adversarial security testing of agentic AI workflows, uncovering prompt injection, tool misuse, and insecure function-calling flaws in **LLM-integrated applications**.
- Automated security regression testing in **CI/CD** using **API fuzzing and authorization checks**, so every change was scanned before reaching production.

Projects

Transformer-Based WAF Pipeline | *Python, FastAPI, PyTorch* — GitHub | Jan. 2026 – Apr. 2026

- Built a reverse-proxy WAF combining sliding-window rate limiting with transformer-based request inspection, and benchmarked it against **ModSecurity with OWASP CRS v4** on 675 labeled real-world payloads, achieving a **96% detection rate vs. 46%**.
- Fine-tuned **DistilBERT** to detect 10 web attack classes, achieving **97.5% detection accuracy** across Path Traversal, SQLi, XSS, SSRF, and IDOR.
- Deployed OWASP Juice Shop, WebGoat, and DVWA behind a Docker Compose reverse-proxy gateway with per-IP rate limiting and monitor, block, and challenge enforcement before reaching the origin.

Technical Skills

Languages: Python, Bash, C++
CS Fundamentals: DSA, OOP, DBMS, Operating Systems, Computer Networks
Security Tools: Burp Suite, Nmap, Metasploit, OWASP ZAP, sqlmap, Nuclei, MobSF, Frida, JADX, Wireshark
Frameworks & Methodologies: MITRE ATT&CK, Cyber Kill Chain, OWASP Top 10
Infra & DevOps: Docker, CI/CD, Linux, Git, PostgreSQL
Networking: TCP/IP, DNS, DHCP, Firewalls, IDS/IPS

Honors & Awards

National 1st Runner-Up, PSB Hackathon Series 2026 – Govt. of India, Central Bank of India & MNNIT Allahabad; outlasted **226 teams** to win **INR 3,00,000**.
Winner (1st Place), NioHack 2026 – Niograph Inc., USA; topped **120+ teams**.
Innovation Award, Cyber AI Hackathon 2026 – University of Derby, UK; most innovative **AI and cybersecurity** solution.
Judge, Internal Smart India Hackathon 2026 – TIET; evaluated **366 teams** (**2,100+** students) on a **90-member panel**.
Top 1% Worldwide on TryHackMe – India Rank **#2,052**, **230+** labs, **300+** day streak.
Intigriti Hall of Fame – **Exceptional (4×)**, **Critical (3×)**, and **Medium (2×)** badges.